\p{property}, \P{property}, \p{!property}	Match a character that is in/not in the given property.
. (period)	Appearing outside brackets, matches any character except a newline. (With the /m option, it matches newline, too).
[characters]	Matches a single character from the specified set.
re*	Matches zero or more occurrences of *re*.
re+	Matches one or more occurrences of *re*.
re{m,n}	Matches at least *m* and at most *n* occurrences of *re*.
re{m,}	Matches at least *m* occurrences of *re*.
re{,n}	Matches at most *n* occurrences of *re*.
re{m}	Matches exactly *m* occurrences of *re*.
re?	Matches zero or one occurrence of *re*. The ?, *, +, and {m,n} modifiers are greedy by default. Append a question mark to make them minimal, and append a plus sign to make them possessive (that is, they are greedy and will not backtrack).
re1 | re2	Matches either *re1* or *re2*.
(...)	Parentheses group regular expressions and introduce extensions.
#{...}	Substitutes expression in the pattern, as with strings. By default, the substitution is performed each time a regular expression literal is evaluated. With the /o option, it is performed just the first time.
\1, \2, ... \n	Match the value matched by the *n*th grouped subexpression.
(?# comment)	Inserts a comment into the pattern.
(?:re)	Makes *re* into a group without generating backreferences.
(?=re), (?!re)	Matches if *re* is/is not at this point but does not consume it.
(?<=re), (?<!re)	Matches if *re* is/is not before this point but does not consume it.
(?>re)	Matches *re* but inhibits subsequent backtracking.
(?adimux), (?-imx)	Turn on/off the corresponding a, d, i, m, u, or x option. If used inside a group, the effect is limited to that group.
(?adimux:re), (?-imx:re)	Turn on/off the i, m, or x option for *re*.
\n, \k'n', and \k<n>	The nth captured subpattern.
(?<name>...) or (?'name'...)	Name the string captured by the group.
\k<name> or \k'name'	The contents of the named group.
\k<name>+/-n or \k'name'+/-n	The contents of the named group at the given relative nesting level.
\g<name> or \g<number>	Invokes the named or numbered group.

Pattern Matching Variables

Ruby sets a number of global variables after a successful regular expression match. These variables are set to nil after an unsuccessful pattern match.